UPSC Civil Services Mains — General Studies Paper I

Indian Heritage and Culture, History and Geography of the World and Society

Syllabus outline for focused preparation

Indian Culture

• Indian culture will cover the salient aspects of Art Forms, literature and Architecture from ancient to modern times.

Modern Indian History

• Modern Indian history from about the middle of the eighteenth century until the present — significant events, personalities, issues.

The Freedom Struggle

• The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country.

Post-Independence India

• Post-independence consolidation and reorganization within the country.

World History

• History of the world will include events from the 18th century such as the Industrial Revolution, world wars, redrawing of national boundaries, colonization, decolonization, political philosophies like communism, capitalism, socialism etc. — their forms and effect on society.

Indian Society

• Salient features of Indian Society, Diversity of India.

• Role of women and women’s organization, population and associated issues, poverty and developmental issues, urbanization, their problems and their remedies.

• Effects of globalization on Indian society.

• Social empowerment, communalism, regionalism and secularism.

Geography

• Salient features of the world’s physical geography.

• Distribution of key natural resources across the world (including South Asia and the Indian sub-continent); factors responsible for the location of primary, secondary, and tertiary sector industries in various parts of the world (including India).

• Important geophysical phenomena such as earthquakes, Tsunami, Volcanic activity, cyclone etc., geographical features and their location — changes in critical geographical features (including water-bodies and ice-caps) and in flora and fauna and the effects of such changes.

Reference: UPSC Civil Services (Main) Examination syllabus. Verify against the latest official UPSC notification for any amendments.